SELF ASSESSMENT · 2025/26 TAX YEAR

Not everyone has to file a tax return.

If your only income is wages or a pension, the tax usually comes off through PAYE — straight out of your pay — and no return is normally due. The question starts the moment money arrives from somewhere else.

THE 2025/26 DEADLINES

31 Jan 2027

The 2025/26 online return is due by 31 January 2027, and the tax the same day. You file if you took over **£1,000** as a sole trader, were a partner, or had Capital Gains Tax.

> Registering after 5 October? HMRC gives you a different filing deadline, 3 months from its letter — but the tax is still due 31 January.

WHO DOES NOT FILE

PAYE

Only wages or a workplace pension? PAYE takes the tax before you are paid, so no return is due.

> The State Pension is not taxed before it reaches you: HMRC collects it through your tax code, or sends a Simple Assessment, which is not a tax return. Two others pull you in — the Child Benefit charge on adjusted net income over £60,000, and a notice to file HMRC has not withdrawn.

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Not sure whether you have to file?

Tell us what came in during the 2025/26 tax year and we will say what to check. No obligation.

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General information. For your own situation, speak to an accountant.